Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-26

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Song of Solomon 3:1-11

1 By night on my bed I sought the one I love; I sought him, but I did not find him.

2 "I will rise now," I said, "And go about the city; In the streets and in the squares I will seek the one I love." I sought him, but I did not find him.

3 The watchmen who go about the city found me; I said, "Have you seen the one I love?"

4 Scarcely had I passed by them, When I found the one I love. I held him and would not let him go, Until I had brought him to the house of my mother, And into the chamber of her who conceived me.

5 I charge you, O daughters of Jerusalem, By the gazelles or by the does of the field, Do not stir up nor awaken love Until it pleases.

6 Who is this coming out of the wilderness Like pillars of smoke, Perfumed with myrrh and frankincense, With all the merchant's fragrant powders?

7 Behold, it is Solomon's couch, With sixty valiant men around it, Of the valiant of Israel.

8 They all hold swords, Being expert in war. Every man has his sword on his thigh Because of fear in the night.

9 Of the wood of Lebanon Solomon the King Made himself a palanquin:

10 He made its pillars of silver, Its support of gold, Its seat of purple, Its interior paved with love By the daughters of Jerusalem.

11 Go forth, O daughters of Zion, And see King Solomon with the crown With which his mother crowned him On the day of his wedding, The day of the gladness of his heart.

II. Key Summary

- By night on her bed she seeks the one she loves; then she rises and seeks him in the

streets and squares. Both times, "I did not find him." She asks the watchmen who go about the city, "Have you seen the one I love?" (vv. 1–3)

• Scarcely has she passed the watchmen when she finds the one she loves; she holds him and will not let him go, and brings him to her mother's house. Then she charges the daughters of Jerusalem, "Do not stir up nor awaken love until it pleases," the same charge as in the previous passage (2:7). (vv. 4–5)

• Coming out of the wilderness like pillars of smoke is Solomon's couch, with sixty valiant men around it, each with a sword on his thigh; the palanquin is made of the wood of Lebanon, with pillars of silver, a support of gold, and a seat of purple. The daughters of Zion are told to go forth and see King Solomon with the crown his mother gave him on the day of his wedding. (vv. 6–11)

III. Passage Analysis

"I Sought Him, but I Did Not Find Him"

> "'Seek'… is always a conscious act, frequently requiring a great deal of effort (e.g., 1 Samuel 10:14; Proverbs 2:4), but with no guarantee of success. The word is repeated here to strengthen the force of the description." [1]

"Seek/sought" appears four times in vv. 1–2, and twice it is followed by "but I did not find him." The first time she seeks him lying on her bed; the second time she says "I will rise now" and goes through the streets and squares (by now it has become a determined "I will," see v. 2). She asks the watchmen and still has no answer; but scarcely has she passed them when she finds the one she loves: "I held him and would not let him go" (vv. 3–4).

When she couldn't find him, she searched harder.

"By the Gazelles or by the Does of the Field"

> "In common life people swore by things which belonged to the subject of conversation or were especially dear to the speaker. As, therefore, the warrior swears by his sword… so here Shulamith by the lovely gazelles, since she is speaking of love." [2]

What she asks the daughters of Jerusalem to promise is "do not stir up nor awaken love" (v.

5), and what she charges them by is the gazelles and the does of the field.

She is speaking of love, so she makes her charge by something connected with love.

Note: Some scholars also point to a play on sounds: in Hebrew, "gazelles" (tsva'ot) is spelled the same as "hosts" in "the LORD of hosts," and "does" ('ayelot) may call to mind "God Almighty" ('El Shaddai). On this view, the two animals she charges by sound like the divine names people usually swore by. The scholar who suggests this offers it with a question mark; see [3] for further reading.

IV. Reflection Question

If you really liked someone, so much that you kept thinking about them while lying in bed at night, but it seemed like the time wasn't right yet, what would you do?

By night on her bed she sought the one she loved, then rose and went about the city; when she found him, she would not let him go. Then she charged the daughters of Jerusalem by the gazelles and the does of the field: "Do not stir up nor awaken love until it pleases" (vv. 1–5).

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), Gleanings on Song of Solomon 3 (Tyndale Old Testament Commentaries), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/22Song/22GT03.htm

[2] BibleHub, Pulpit Commentary (quoting Ewald), Song of Solomon 2:7 (3:5 repeats the charge of 2:7), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/songs/2-7.htm

[3] Sefaria source sheet, quoting Michael Fishbane, The JPS Bible Commentary: Song of Songs (further reading; not a whitelist source), https://www.sefaria.org.il/sheets/526047